# PROJECT WORTH

## SAFE CHURCHES PROTECT KIDS

*Truth heals. Jesus puts children first.*

Project Worth believes the words sexual abuse and church do not belong in the same sentence **unless the church is preventing it.**

Churches hold some of the deepest public trust. That trust must be protected with clear boundaries, strong policies, accountability, and a commitment to put children before leaders, reputations, or institutions.

### WHAT GROOMING CAN LOOK LIKE

Grooming in churches may look like special attention, gifts, private messages, unnecessary one-on-one time, secrecy, boundary crossing, or using Scripture, obedience, forgiveness, or spiritual authority to gain control.

### SAFE CHURCHES

- Listen to children and survivors, and take concerns seriously
- Report suspected abuse and use independent accountability
- Require screening, training, supervision, and clear boundaries
- Never protect a leader or reputation over a child
- Support survivors without blame, pressure, or forced forgiveness
- Respect survivors' boundaries and decisions about faith
- Have policies in place that protect children first

### CHILD SEXUAL ABUSE IS NOT RARE

At least 1 in 4 girls and 1 in 20 boys experience child sexual abuse, most often by someone they

Church-specific data is incomplete, but documented cases show that abuse can occur in any faith community or denomination.

No church can assume abuse could never happen within its walls.

**Abuse is never a survivor's fault.**

God did not cause it.

### FINDING FAITH AFTER ABUSE

Some survivors may reconnect with faith. Others may need distance from church or religion. Both deserve respect. Safe churches do not pressure survivors to return. They listen, believe, acknowledge harm, respect boundaries, and support healing wherever the survivor is.

**PROTECTING CHILDREN IS NOT AN ATTACK ON THE CHURCH.**
**ACCOUNTABILITY IS NOT THE ENEMY OF GRACE.**

CHILDREN MATTER. • SURVIVORS MATTER. • NO LEADER IS ABOVE ACCOUNTABILITY.

### INVITE PROJECT WORTH

Project Worth offers prevention training and survivor-informed speakers for churches, ministries, schools, and community organizations.

Sign up for a training or request a speaker at **projectworthwi.org**